1. CONTENTS



144 Mahjong Cards



25 South Round Cards



6 Extra Blank Cards



2 Dice

2. UNDERSTANDING MAHJONG

The Three Types Of Cards

1. Suit Cards

There are 3 suits in Mahjong, and each suit has 4 cards for each number from 1 to 9.



Bamboos/Boos



Characters/Cracks



Dots/Circles

2. Honour Cards

Honour Cards are the cards that do not have numbers on them. There are 2 types of Honour Cards - Winds & Dragons.

- **Wind Cards** - There are 4 types of Wind Cards - East, South, West & North. There are 4 cards of each Wind.



- **Dragon Cards** - There are 3 colours of Dragon Cards - Red, Green and White. There are 4 cards of each Dragon.



3. Flower Cards

Flower Cards include **Flower Cards** and **Season Cards**. They serve as bonus cards and are used to score extra points. The numbers on them connect to Winds: 1 is East, 2 is South, 3 is West & 4 is North.



The Sets

1. Pung (Three of a Kind/Trio)

3 identical cards, with the same number and suit.

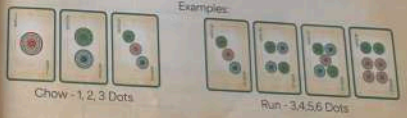
Examples:



2. Chow/Run (Pure Sequence)

3 consecutive cards of the same suit is a Chow.
4 or more consecutive cards of the same suit is a Run.

Examples:



3. Pure Pair

2 identical cards, with the same number and suit.

Examples:



7s in Bamboos



Red Dragons

4. Crochet

3 of the same number, each one of a different suit.



4s in Dots, Cracks, Bamboos



9s in Dots, Cracks, Bamboos

5. Knit

2 of the same number, each one of a different suit. (You can only make a Knit if you have made a Crochet in the same hand as well.)



2s in Dots, Cracks



5s in Bamboos, Dots

6. Kong

4 identical cards, with the same number and suit.



4s in Dots



9s in Cracks

Rules for Kongs:

- When you make a Kong, you must place it down, without disclosing it, so you still have a Concealed hand. In this case, you must pick an extra card from the Flower Wall, so that you have enough cards to make the rest of your sets. In short, even though a Kong has 4 cards, it counts as 3 cards when you declare a 14-card Mahjong.
- This rule applies if you have an exposed Kong as well. You must pick an extra card from the Flower Wall as soon as you make your Exposed Kong.

Rounds

Mahjong has 16 rounds; but since Mahjong Go is a shortened version, there are just 4 rounds in this game.

The 4 rounds of this game are called **EAST ROUND, SOUTH ROUND, WEST ROUND, and NORTH ROUND**, and they are played in that order.

East → South → West → North

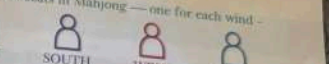
If you're a pro Mahjong player and prefer to play all 16 rounds, you can do that too!

The goal of each round is to declare "**Mahjong**" by using the 14 cards in your hand to create specific combinations of sets depending on the round you are playing.



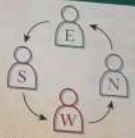
3. SEATING

There are 4 seats in Mahjong — one for each wind -



Each player takes one of these directions for a round. Every player rolls both the dice. The player who rolls the highest total is the "EAST PLAYER" and also the dealer, for the first round (The East Round).

The player sitting to EAST's right is SOUTH. The next player to SOUTH's right is WEST, followed by NORTH.



An easy way to remember this is **Eat Soup With Noodles** - counterclockwise.

It's also important to know that the East Player is Player 1, South is Player 2, West is Player 3, and North is Player 4. This is important for scoring if you collect Flower Cards.

Note: Each player will be the East Player at least once. The East position (Player) moves counterclockwise each round.

4. DEALING CARDS

Dealing Cards in the following way must be done at the start of every round.

1. Each player is dealt 36 cards.



2. Then, the EAST PLAYER for that round rolls the dice. The total of the numbers the dice land on is doubled. For example, if the total of the two dice is 8, 8 is doubled = **16**.

3. The East Player removes 16 cards from their deck of 36 and places it in a pile next to them. This is considered the **FLOWER WALL**.



16 cards = Flower Wall

4. Then, the EAST PLAYER begins dealing with the cards left in their deck starting with the player to their right. They must deal 13 cards to each player.

5. If their deck of cards gets over before they have dealt 13 cards to each player, the player to their right (SOUTH PLAYER) begins dealing cards from their deck, continuing on from where the EAST PLAYER left off, until all players have 13 cards.

6. Then, the EAST PLAYER is dealt a 14th card.

Everyone then places their extra cards (from the 36 cards dealt at the start) in the center as the Draw Pile. All players now have 13 cards, and the EAST PLAYER has 14 cards. The Flower Wall is kept as it is.

Players pick up their cards. If they have any **Flower or Season** cards, they place them face up in front of them to add to their score later and draw a replacement card from the Flower Wall that is in front of the EAST PLAYER. This is something that players must do throughout the game, if they pick up a Flower or Season Card.

5.CALLING CARDS

Each round has its own goal – specific sequences or sets you need to form to win. Players take turns drawing and discarding cards to build these combinations. You can also "call" a card that another player discards, but there are special rules about when and how you can "call" a discarded card.

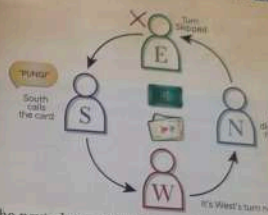
1. Any player can "call" a card only to **complete** a Pung

- Any player can claim a discarded card to **complete** a Pung (three identical cards) by calling "Pung!" This means they cannot call the card unless it's the **3rd card**, that completes the Pung.



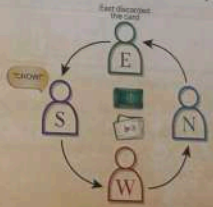
- The player who calls the card must immediately open and display the Pung in front of them for everyone to see.

- After calling "Pung!", the player must discard a card. Play then continues with the player to the right of the one that called the card. For example, if the North player discarded a card and South called it, it's West's turn next, even if this means a player skipped a turn in the middle.



2. Only the next player after the one who discarded the card can call a card to **complete** a Pure Chow.

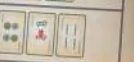
- A player may claim a discarded card to **complete** a Chow (a sequence of three in the same suit) by calling "Chow!" **only from the player to their left.**



- Players are not allowed to call the card unless it completes their Chow
- The player who calls the card must immediately open their set in front of them for everyone to see.

3. Restrictions on Calling

- Players **cannot claim** a discarded card (even from the previous player) for:

Mixed Run/Chow	
A Pair	
A Knit	
A Crochet	

Unless the card completes their hand to Mahjong.

4. When Two Players "Call" a card at the same time

- If there is a case, where a player calls a card to declare Mahjong, at the same time as another player calls the same card to complete a Pung, the player who calls the card to Mahjong gets the card.

- If two players call Mahjong on the same card, the card goes to the player whose turn is closest in order of turns.
  Example: If West discards a card and both East and North call the card to Mahjong, North gets the card because North's turn is next.

If you call a card, you must place the set you completed face up in front of you. This means you have an EXPOSED HAND.

If you Mahjong without calling any cards, and reveal all your cards at the end, it means you have a CONCEALED HAND. Having a Concealed Hand wins you more points. You can refer to the Scoring Section for more details.

6. STARTING SCORE

Every player starts the game with a score of 35, 000 points.
Use a notepad or your phone to keep track of the points.

7. HOW TO PLAY THE DIFFERENT ROUNDS

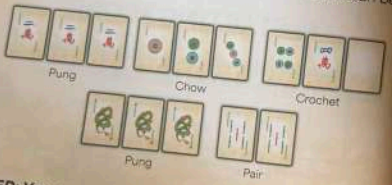
The game begins with the **EAST ROUND.**

Remember, that the player who rolled the highest total is Player 1 i.e the East Player for this East Wind Round.

TO MAHJONG:

The first player to make a complete combination of their 14 cards of **4 sets** of 3 cards each and **1 set** of 2 cards can Mahjong.

In this round for the sets of 3 cards, players can make Pungs, Chows, Mixed Chows and Crochets. The set of 2 cards can be a Pure Pair or a Knit.



REMEMBER: You can make a Knit only if you have also made a Crochet.

How to play

1. The East player begins. They are already dealt 14 cards. They start the game by discarding a card from their hand into the discard pile. **Players must always announce the card they are discarding.** (For example, say "5 Cracks". Then, it's the South Player's turn (unless another player "calls" a card.)



2. On your turn, you must first pick a card from the draw pile, and then discard a card.
(REMEMBER: If you pick a Flower or a Wind card, place it down, and pick a replacement card from the Flower Wall.)

The round continues until a player picks up a card (**therefore has 14 cards**) and declares Mahjong. Then, the round is over and everyone must reveal their cards, total their scores, and note them down.

Note: If you're a pro Mahjong player, and prefer to play the passport variation, you can feel free to do so.

SCORING FOR THE EAST ROUND:

Every player starts with **35,000 points.** Use a notepad or your phone to keep a track of the points.

1. Exposed Hand

- If a player (other than East) calls Mahjong with an exposed hand, they get 500 points from each of the other two players, and 1000 points from the East player.



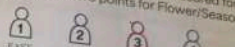
- If East calls Mahjong with an exposed hand, then all players pay 1000 points.

2. Concealed Hand

- If a player (other than East) calls Mahjong with a Concealed hand, they get 1000 points from each of the other two players, and 2000 points from the East player.
- If East calls Mahjong with a Concealed hand, then all players pay them 2000 points.

ADDITIONAL POINTS FOR SEASON & FLOWER PAIRS

These points are scored in addition to points scored for declaring Mahjong. All players can score points for Flower/Season cards.



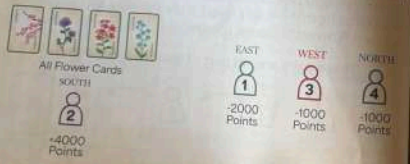
- **Pair of Seating Wind:** If a player (other than East) has a pair of their seating number Flowers/Seasons (For example, Player 2 (South) has a pair of Flowers/Seasons with their seating wind, they receive 500 points from each of the other two players, and 1000 points from the East player). If the East player has a pair of their own Flowers/Seasons, they receive 1000 points from each player.

These pairs are not part of your Mahjong Hand.



- **Pair of Round Wind:** If a player (other than East) has a pair of the Round's Flowers/Seasons, (i.e. 1 as it is the East Round), they receive 500 points from each of the other two players and 1000 points from the East player. If the East player has a pair of the Round's Flowers/Seasons, they receive 1000 points from each player.

- **Pure Bouquet:** If a player (other than East) has a pure bouquet (1,2,3,4 of Flowers or 1,2,3,4 of Seasons), they receive 1000 points from each of the other two players and 2000 points from the East player. If East has a pure bouquet, they receive 2000 points from each player.



- **Mixed Bouquet:** If a player (other than East) has a mixed bouquet (any combination of 1,2,3,4 from Flowers or Seasons), they receive 500 points from each of the other two players and 1000 points from the East player. If East has a mixed bouquet, they receive 1000 points from each player.



- **Note: Even if you are not the one to declare Mahjong, you can still collect points if you have Season/Flower Pairs or Bouquets.**

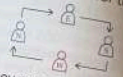
- **Once the East Round is over, the South Round begins.**

7. HOW TO PLAY THE DIFFERENT ROUNDS

THE SOUTH ROUND

Now, **the next player, counterclockwise is the East Player.** The rest of the players assume winds according to this.

The cards are dealt as usual, with the East player for the South round being dealt 14 cards.



TO MAHJONG:

- Every player picks a South Card. They must not show this to the other players. This card determines their own personal goal for the round, in order to declare Mahjong.

KNOW YOUR CARD



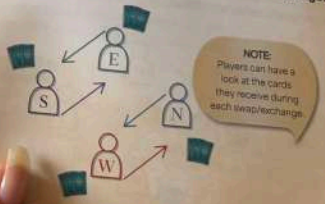
- This is just one example—there are plenty of ways to reach the same Mahjong goal.
- If the table wants, each player can pick 3 South Cards and can choose any 1 of the cards as their goal card, and discard the rest.

Before you start playing the South Round, you must carry out an exchange of cards called the Charleston Exchange or the RAL (Right, Across, Left) Exchange.

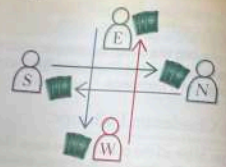
Steps for the Charleston Exchange:

In this exchange, after all the players have seen their cards, they take turns giving each other 3 cards of their choice.

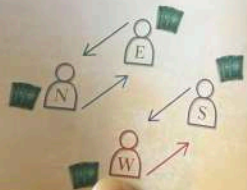
Step 1: East exchanges 3 cards with South, and North exchanges 3 cards with West.



Step 2: East exchanges 3 cards with West, and North exchanges 3 cards with South.



Step 3: Lastly, East exchanges 3 cards with North, and South exchanges 3 cards with West.



Note: This is called the **RAL (Right, Across, Left) Exchange**. Because looking from the **East player's point of view**, they exchange cards with the player on their **right** first, then with the player **across** them, and then with the player on their **left** - in that order, therefore **R-A-L**!

Note: If you're a pro Mahjong player, and would like to perform more exchanges (Tic, tac, toe, or others,) please feel free to do so.

How to play

The rules and gameplay for this round are the same as the steps in the East Round. There are 3 differences:

1. The goal for each player is different - defined by their South Card.
2. Players must engage in an exchange of cards.
3. Players can **BUY** cards throughout this round.

BUYING CARDS

In the South Round, players can **BUY** the card discarded from the player to their **left**. To buy a card, the player must give up 100 points (These points keep getting added to a common pot, that goes to the player who declares Mahjong for that round.)

- **Bought cards do not need to complete a set or be displayed. They are kept concealed in the player's hand and can be used to make any set.**
- **After a player buys a card, they must discard a card. Play continues with the player whose turn comes after the one who bought the card.**
- **Play continues until a player declares Mahjong!**

SCORING FOR THE SOUTH ROUND

- The number of points you win if you Mahjong is mentioned on the bottom of your South Card.
- If a player (other than East) calls Mahjong, they collect the points shown on the card from each of the other two players (not including East), and double the points they receive from the East player.
- If the East player calls Mahjong, all three other players pay double the points shown on the card to the East player.

- **Once the South Round is over, the West Round begins.**

7. HOW TO PLAY THE DIFFERENT ROUNDS.

THE WEST ROUND - This round is also known as GOULASH!

Now, **the next player counterclockwise is the East Player.** The rest of the players assume their winds according to this.

The cards are dealt as usual, with the East player for the West Round being dealt 14 cards.

TO MAHJONG:

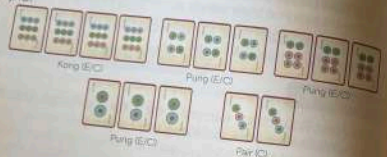
- In the West Round, you can only make **Kongs, Pungs, and Pairs,** but you must have **at least 1 Kong to Mahjong.**
- You can only declare Mahjong if:

You have a Clean Hand!
(A hand is considered a clean hand if there are cards of only one suit and/or Honour Cards.)

• In the West Round, you can only declare Mahjong if you have certain combinations of cards:

1. All your Pungs, Kongs and Pairs are in the **same suit** (Exposed or Concealed).

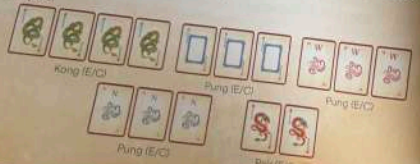
Example:



OR

2. All your Pungs, Kongs and Pairs are made with **only Honour Cards** (only Winds and Dragons).

Example:



2. Your hand is made of a **combination of** Honour Cards and any one suit.

If you have both Honour cards and cards of any 1 suit, you must make one of the combinations below to Mahjong.

• You can make 4 Exposed Kongs and a Pair.

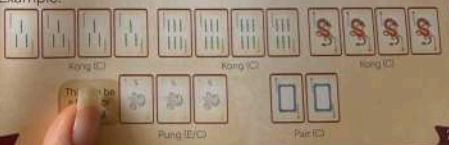
Example:



OR

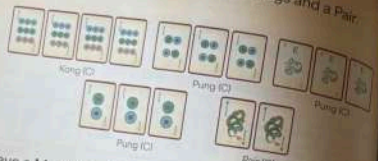
• You can make 3 Concealed Kongs, 1 Kong/Pung and a Pair.

Example:



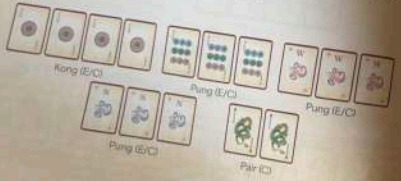
• You can make a Concealed mix of Pungs, Kongs and a Pair.

Example:

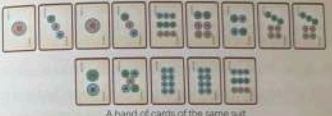


4. If you have a **Major Hand** (Pungs, Kongs and Pairs of only **1s** and **9s** in any **one suit** and **with Honour Cards).**

Example:



5. If you have a **Bouquet** (Cards 1 to 4 of Seasons and/or Flowers). In this case, the cards in your hand, even if they don't form Pungs, Kongs, and Pairs, must be of the same suit and/or Honour Cards.



A hand of cards of the same suit



Mixed Bouquet

Before you start playing the West Round, you must carry out an exchange of cards called the Charleston Exchange or the RAL (Right, Across, Left) Exchange. Refer to this section in the South Round for a reminder of how this works!

If you are a pro Mahjong Player and prefer to play with your own Goulash rules, please feel free to do so!

How to play

The rules for this round are the same as the steps in the East Round. The East Player starts play and the game continues as per usual, with everyone working towards the goal of declaring Mahjong first.

There are some important things to keep in mind in this round:

1. You must engage in this Charleston Exchange before you start the round.
2. You cannot buy cards in the round, you can however, call cards to make exposed Kongs and Pungs.
3. If the draw pile is over before someone declares Mahjong, the round is considered a draw, and based on the table's choice, you can choose to play the round from start again. If a draw is declared you only win points for Flower/Wind sets.

SCORING FOR THE WEST ROUND:

The scoring for the West Round in Mahjong is a lot more complicated and detailed than what we suggest here. It's based on making Doubles, with a clean hand. If you prefer to follow those rules please feel free; but for those of you who don't know them, this is a great way to get started and/or keep it simple!

Scoring for the West Round is dependent on what combination of cards you declare Mahjong with.

You get points for Flower and Season Cards you have collected. Refer to the "Flower and Season Scoring" section in the rules for the East Round to add these points.

Refer to the table to see how many points you win for different combinations. It's important to remember that you get double these points from the East Player, and if the East Player declares Mahjong, they get double these points from every player.

YOUR HAND	POINTS EARNED FROM EACH PLAYER (Double all these from the East Player, and double all these from everyone if the East Player declares Mahjong)
All your Pungs, Kongs and Pairs are in the same suit.	Exposed Hand - 1000 Concealed Hand - 2000
All your Pungs, Kongs and Pairs are made with only Honour Cards.	Exposed Hand - 1500 Concealed Hand - 2500
For 4 Exposed Kongs and a Pair with only Honour Cards and/or any 1 Suit.	1500
For 3 Concealed Kongs, a Pair, and any Pung/Kong with only Honour Cards and/or any 1 Suit.	2000
For a Concealed mix of Pungs, Kongs and a Pair with only Honour Cards and/or any 1 Suit.	2000
For a Concealed mix of Pungs, Kongs and a Pair with only Honour Cards and/or any 1 Suit.	1500
A Major Hand	1500
A Bouquet (with a Clean Hand)	2000

Once the West Round is over, the North R... t round) begins!

7. HOW TO PLAY THE DIFFERENT ROUNDS.

THE NORTH ROUND

Now, the next player counterclockwise is the East Player.

The rest of the cards are dealt as usual, with the East Player for the North Round being dealt 14 cards.

In the North Round, the East Player for this round decides which round (East, South or West) they want to play as the North Round. Once the player decides which round they want to play, players must follow these rules:

1. If you are playing the East Round as the North Round:
You simply play the East Round. There are no added rules.

2. If you are playing the South Round as the North Round:
You use the South Cards to find out what you need in order to Mahjong, as usual, but with some differences:

- All Flowers/Seasons are considered Jokers and remain a part of the 14 cards in your hand. You can use these cards in your hand as any card to make a winning hand. (Make sure you do not reveal your Flower/Season cards in this ...).





• Players do not get extra points for Flowers/Seasons. The rest of the rules are the same as the rules for the South Round.

3. If you are playing the West Round as the North Round.

You play the regular West Round but with some differences:

• The East Player for the North Round chooses a number as the "Joker Number". They can do this after they have seen the 14 cards they are dealt.

For example, if the East player picks 5 as the Joker, Players can use a 5 in Bamboos, 5 in Cracks, and 5 in Dots, as a Joker.

But remember, **while using Jokers when the South and West Rounds are being played as the North Round:**

You can use **one or more Jokers**, but **never identical Jokers.**



• Buying is not allowed.

RULES TO REMEBER

1. If you **pick a discarded card** to complete a set using a Joker, **the Joker must be exposed.**

2. If you have an **exposed set** that includes a Joker and later **draw a card from the wall** that fits in your set, you can **replace the Joker** with the drawn card and, take the Joker back into your hand.

3. You **cannot replace a Joker** in an exposed set **when taking a discarded card.**

4. A Joker cannot be used to form a pair.

SCORING FOR THE NORTH ROUND:

Scoring is based on and is the same as the round the East Player chooses to play - barring the exceptions!